

Complementing Conventional Tumor Markers in Stage IV Colorectal Cancer

When the tumor marker is **not expressed**, follow the disease molecularly with OncoAlibrex®.



CLINICAL BACKGROUND

A 65-year-old male with Stage IV colorectal cancer presented with extensive metastatic disease involving the liver and right lung. The tumor was KRAS wild-type and right-sided, and the patient did not express CEA, limiting the utility of CEA as a biomarker for longitudinal disease monitoring.



Beyond CEA

A tumor-associated antigen this patient's tumor did not express.



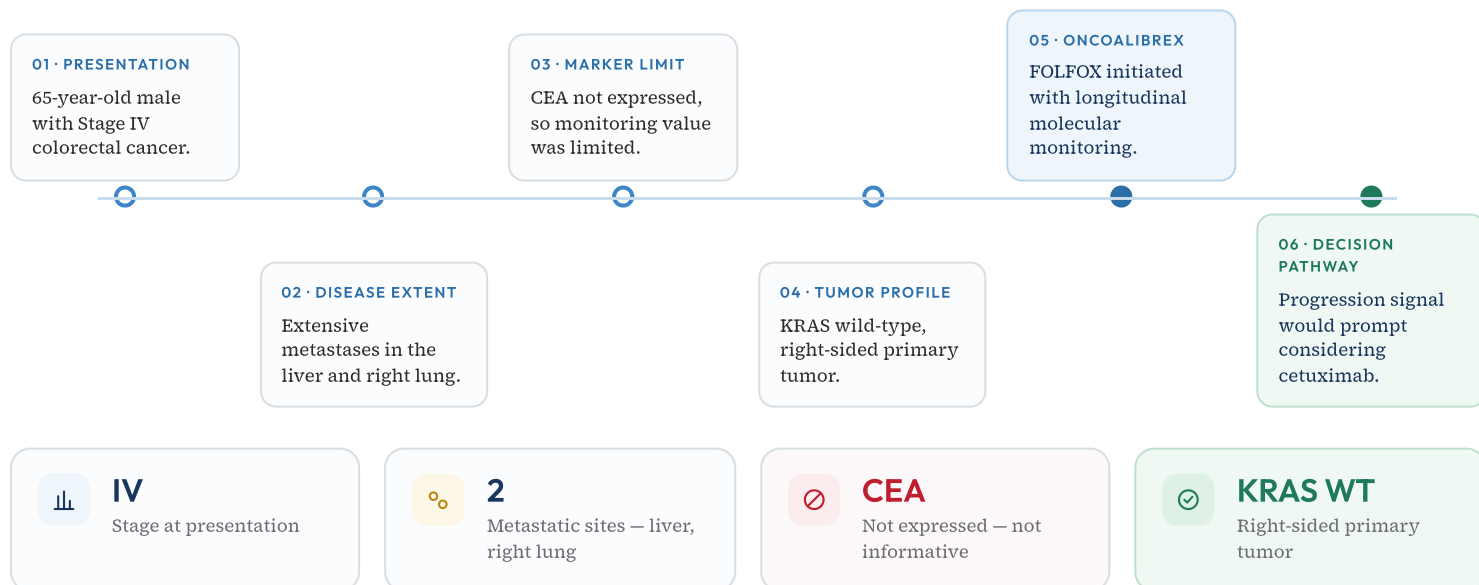
Monitoring that continues

Longitudinal molecular assessment during therapy.

PATIENT	DIAGNOSIS	CHALLENGE	KEY FINDING
65M Colorectal primary	Stage IV Colorectal Cancer Liver and right lung metastases	CEA Not Expressed Limited utility for monitoring	OncoAlibrex was used as an additional molecular monitoring tool alongside FOLFOX, with a pathway to consider adding cetuximab on a progression signal.

The Monitoring Journey

From an uninformative serum marker to a defined, molecularly guided decision pathway.



WHY THIS CASE MATTERS

This case illustrates the potential application of OncoAlibrex in a patient for whom CEA was not informative. Rather than relying on a tumor-associated antigen that was not expressed by the patient's tumor, longitudinal molecular monitoring provided an additional approach for evaluating disease behavior during therapy.

Stage IV Colorectal Cancer — CEA-Negative Monitoring

Case parameters · OncoAlibrex® — longitudinal molecular monitoring during FOLFOX



CASE - DEFINING CLINICAL FINDINGS

SOURCE	FINDING	CLINICAL IMPACT
SERUM	CEA not expressed	Limits the utility of CEA as a biomarker for longitudinal disease monitoring
DNA	KRAS wild-type	Tumor genotype documented in this case
CLINICAL	Right-sided primary tumor	Tumor characteristic recorded at presentation
IMAGING	Metastases — liver and right lung	Extensive metastatic disease at presentation
THERAPY	FOLFOX chemotherapy	Systemic treatment the patient was initiated on
MONITOR	OncoAlibrex — longitudinal	An additional molecular monitoring tool during treatment
PLAN	Cetuximab on progression signal	If OncoAlibrex indicated disease progression, the physician planned to consider adding cetuximab

Why the modality matters

A marker the tumor does not express cannot track the disease — molecular monitoring gave the team a second view.

CEA monitoring — marker only

The tumor did not express the antigen the test measures.

CEA expression	Absent
Longitudinal utility	Limited
Response signal	Not informative

NO INFORMATIVE MARKER

→

OncoAlibrex — molecular monitoring

Longitudinal assessment independent of antigen expression.

Antigen dependence	None
Monitoring during FOLFOX	Longitudinal
Escalation pathway	Defined

ADDITIONAL MOLECULAR SIGNAL

KEY CLINICAL TAKEAWAY

When conventional tumor-marker monitoring is not informative, longitudinal molecular assessment may provide an additional signal for evaluating treatment response and informing potential treatment escalation.

BROADER CLINICAL IMPLICATIONS

- Confirm the marker informs**

Where a tumor does not express the antigen, marker-based monitoring carries little information.
- Follow the disease molecularly**

Longitudinal molecular assessment adds a view of disease behavior during therapy.
- Define the escalation in advance**

Decide what a progression signal would change before treatment begins.

OncoAlibrex® is a longitudinal molecular monitoring assay. CEA, carcinoembryonic antigen; FOLFOX, folinic acid, fluorouracil and oxaliplatin; KRAS, Kirsten rat sarcoma viral oncogene homolog; WT, wild-type. Presented for illustrative purposes.

Learn More at 1Cell.AI

Mail - info@1cell.ai | Tel - 1800 123 12355

1Cell.AI © Copyright 2026. All rights reserved | Scan QR to know more